

Zoha Javaid

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Lead Talent Acquisition Specialist with 4+ years driving end-to-end technical hiring across APAC, MENA, and EMEA within global software and financial services environments. Known for building high-performing talent pipelines from zero infrastructure, achieving 90%+ offer acceptance and cutting time-to-hire by up to 80%. Deep expertise in ATS, structured interviewing frameworks, and delivering an exceptional candidate experience at scale.

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|--------------------|-----------|-------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| • Google Workspace | • Notion | • Juicebox (People GPT) | • LinkedIn Recruiter | • ChatGPT+ |
| • GreenHouse | • Lattice | • Ashby | • Figma | • Apollo.io |
| • Claude code | • Github | • Rube | • Fizzy | |

Key Achievements

- Built HR & Talent functions from the ground up at **ZAR (venture-backed)** and **Jillion (bootstrapped)**, transforming them from zero infrastructure into scalable, high-performing operations.
- Scaled hiring across **APAC, MENA, and EMEA**, filling 80+ tech strategic roles with **90%+ offer acceptance rates**.
- Recruited **C-suite and senior leaders** (Head of Product, Head of Engineering), accelerating product and engineering delivery.
- Attracted top-tier talent from **Klarna, N26, Stripe, Talabat, Hungerstation, Delivery Hero, and Revolut**, enhancing technical capabilities, accelerating product delivery, and reinforcing company culture.
- Independently designed and deployed a **full-stack HR portal using AI (Claude Code)**, eliminating reliance on engineering resources and reducing leave approval turnaround from days to minutes across a distributed team.
- Organized **4 international offsites (Indonesia, UAE, Qatar, Pakistan)**, boosting cross-regional collaboration and retention.

Experience

ZAR | December 2024 - Present

Backed by leading Web3 investors a16z, DragonFly Capital and VanEck; raised USD \$12.9M

Global Talent Lead

Team Building & Expansion

- Built the entire HR and Talent Acquisition function from scratch, including policies, processes, interview loops, and recruitment tooling to support future scaling.
- Independently shipped a fully automated, AI-assisted HR portal — enabling self-serve leave management, one-click manager approvals, and real-time notifications; built end-to-end using Claude Code with zero engineering support.
- Scaled high-performing engineering and operations teams across APAC, MENA, and EMEA, hiring blockchain, Flutter, Ruby, DevOps, Mobile and FinOps talent that met 100% of critical headcount needs.

Global Talent Strategy & Planning

- Partnered directly with the CEO and CTO to define headcount plans, organizational structure, and quarterly hiring priorities.
- Researched and evaluated global employment and compliance partners (Deel, Remote, Toku) to identify the best-fit provider for global hiring needs.
- Built 15+ cross-platform automation recipes using Rube MCP integrating Gmail, Calendar, and Google Sheets to streamline recruitment workflows, reducing candidate outreach time by 80%.
- Developed AI-assisted onboarding agent that autonomously manages new hire first-week experience, cutting coordination overhead from 8 hours to 30 minutes per employee.

Employee Engagement & Culture

- Designed and led ZAR's first company offsite in Bali, Indonesia and Dubai, UAE— managed accommodation, transportation, activities, and budget to ensure an enjoyable, productive, and well-organized team experience.

Jillion | December 2023- December 2024

Bootstrapped company; operations closed in 2024

Global Talent Partner - Tech

Team Building & Expansion

- Successfully built and expanded teams in Product Engineering (software engineers, product managers, product designers), Data, Security, Risk & Fraud, FinOps, Sales and IT Support, achieving a 90% offer acceptance rate and maintaining project efficiency.
- Led Tech recruiting across EMEA, GCC, and MENAP regions, successfully fulfilling 60% of key roles and ensuring the company's competitive edge in these markets.

Global Talent Strategy & Planning

- Aligned talent acquisition with business goals by collaborating with the CTO, CEO, and Head of People & Culture, resulting in a 20% reduction in time-to-hire.
- Developed and managed hiring budgets, effectively allocating resources, which led to a 15% increase in cost efficiency across teams.
- Spearheaded global talent mapping initiatives, expanding the Tech function across six regions, contributing to a 25% increase in global company growth.

Employee and Candidate Engagement

- Organized and facilitated global team meetups in Doha, Qatar, and Islamabad, Pakistan, by planning itineraries, coordinating events, and managing logistics, which strengthened team cohesion and company culture.
- Led company-wide presentations during global meetups to introduce new hires, explain benefits, and reinforce company values, improving employee engagement and alignment.

Recruitment Process Design

- Authored and implemented a comprehensive recruiting guideline on Notion, standardizing the recruitment and selection process across the company, resulting in a more consistent and efficient hiring experience.
- Created visual flowcharts in Figma to illustrate the hiring process, enhancing transparency and understanding for stakeholders.

Sadapay Private Limited | May 2022 - December 2023

Acquired by Papara after 5 years of operations; raised USD \$10.7M Seed funding

Talent Specialist 2

Key Recruitment and Technical Focus Areas

- Sourced and recruited top talent across product, engineering, design, and security functions — from Head of Product to DevOps and Data Engineers — leveraging LinkedIn Recruiter, advanced Boolean search, and expertise in TDD, XP, and tech stacks including Spring Boot, JavaScript, Kotlin, Swift, and Data Analytics.

Global Recruitment Strategy & Process Improvement

- Orchestrated a transformation in the recruitment process, reducing the average TAT for technology roles from a daunting 8 weeks to an impressive 10 business days, enhancing organizational agility.
- Integrated Codu.ai's coding assessment tool with Greenhouse ATS, streamlining engineer hiring workflows, and conducted efficiency analysis by benchmarking candidate results against engineer evaluations to verify platform accuracy.
- Developed and distributed instructive emails to improve candidate interactions with evaluation platforms like Criteria and Codu.ai, enhancing candidate experience and TAT.

Global Stakeholder Management & Communication

- Partnered with global stakeholders to identify recruitment process improvements, leading to better alignment with business objectives.
- Identified and addressed scheduling challenges in the Product Design function by onboarding all Product Designers as interviewers, enhancing capacity and readiness.

Talent Specialist 1 | February 2023- September 2023

Global Recruitment Strategy & Planning

- Sourced and recruited top technical talent for global roles, including software engineers, data scientists, product managers, and UX designers.
- Built strong relationships with international hiring managers and technical stakeholders, developing sourcing and selection strategies that met diverse global needs.
- Crafted and refined job descriptions to align with SadaPay's culture and diversity goals, ensuring the recruitment of top-tier global talent.

Process Improvement & Stakeholder Management

- Conducted regular team meetings and one-on-one sessions with recruiters to review progress against hiring goals, share best practices, and ensure alignment with company and departmental objectives.
- Collaborated with the employer branding team to develop and execute talent attraction and retention campaigns, including social media posts, employee testimonials, and community events.

Recruiting Coordinator | May 2022 - February 2023

Recruitment Strategy & Planning

- Led end-to-end recruitment processes for technical positions across multiple regions, ensuring timely and successful hiring.
- Developed job descriptions, postings, and selection criteria aligned with company values, culture, and objectives.

Education

Master of Management Sciences (MS-MS) | Bahira University | September 2021- February 2023 | CGPA: 3.87

Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) | National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences | August 2017 – June 2021 | CGPA: 3.80